MORE PUZZLES, MORE FUN FULL PAGE IN LIFE

WEEK IN REVIEW THIS WEEK'S TOP NEWS, 5A

USA TODAY WEEKEND

THE NATION'S NEWS | $3 | MARCH 27-29, 2026

MLB payrolls: See who has highest

Find out which team tops the list, and it isn't the Dodgers despite it drawing the most heat. **In Sports**

Is baby boom here? It's complicated

Trump administration's efforts to counter declining birth rate meet obstacles. **In Weekend Extra**

MIKE COPPOLA/ GETTY IMAGES

Taylor Frankie Paul fallout could grow

News & Views: "Mormon Wives" personality might be downfall of "Bachelor" franchise. **In Life**

Fleeing Mideast has been struggle

Americans say U.S. help was too little, too late

Callie Carmichael
USA TODAY

Emaan Abbass, a beauty consultant from the United States, had been living in Dubai for more than nine years. She said she'd felt secure and safe living in there until the war with Iran began on Feb. 28. But when she started hearing loud booms overhead from Iran's counterattack on the United Arab Emirates, a U.S. ally, she decided it was time to get out.

Abbass saw the headlines and started seeing video from social media the weekend the war started. But neither she nor her sister had received any direct communication from the U.S. State Department.

A smoke plume rises from a fire near Dubai International Airport in the United Arab Emirates on March 16. AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

By March 2, she was still hearing "loud booms" overhead, so she enrolled in the STEP program, a free service for U.S. citizens and nationals so that the State Department can contact them in case of an emergency. On the MyTravel.gov website, one of the benefits of the program is to "Help the embassy or consulate contact you if there's an emergency like a natural disaster, civil unrest, or a family emergency."

Although she still had not been contacted directly, she said, she saw on social media that the U.S. government was urging Americans to evacuate certain countries in the Middle East, including the UAE.

In the social media post, it gave two numbers for Americans who needed emergency assistance. One of the phone numbers listed did not work internationally. She said the other led to recorded messages which offered no

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Trump on Iran war: 'They want to make a deal'

Leaders in Tehran say no negotiation talks are underway. **3A**

No Kings protests set this weekend across U.S.

Over 3,100 events planned nationwide to rally against Trump's policies. **2A**

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WOMEN OF THE YEAR

Angel City plays to win for women, their community

LA soccer team is creating its own path to long-term success

Wendy Naugle USA TODAY

If you're heading to your first Angel City Football Club home game at BMO Stadium in Los Angeles, you will experience a vibe. Girls wearing too-large player jerseys – their dads in pink wigs. PodeRosas, a group of Spanish-speaking supporters, chanting, "*Dale, dale,* ACFC. *Dale*, Angel City." • You'll see grandmas and girlfriends. Celebrity owners and families. Huge flags in the team's colors, black and Sol Rosa – a dusty pink representing the Southern California sun and horizon. The omnipresent bass drums will make you want to dance. • And when the home team scores, everyone will be on their feet. • Willow Bay, journalist and dean of the USC Annenberg School, remembers her first game. It was the team's inaugural season, and it was electric. "I was blown away," she says. "It just felt special. It felt different, and it felt joyful in a way that kind of took my breath away."

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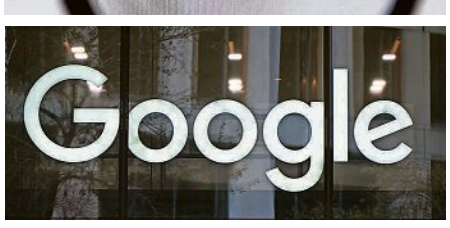
About the Women of the Year project

USA TODAY's Women of the Year is a recognition of women who have made a significant impact in their communities and across the country.

Meet this year's honorees at **womenoftheyear.usatoday.com**.

ABOVE: Savy King, left, Julie Uhrman, Riley Tiernan, Willow Bay, Sarah Gorden and Kara Nortman at Angel City FC's practice facility in Thousand Oaks, California. MATTEA LINAE FOR USA TODAY



A jury found Meta and Google were negligent in the designs of Instagram and YouTube and failed to warn about their dangers. AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Jury finds Meta, Google liable in social media addiction trial

Test case could open floodgates for litigation

Melina Khan
USA TODAY

A jury has found Meta and Google liable for $3 million in damages on March 25 in a landmark trial over allegations that their popular social media apps, including Instagram and YouTube, are designed to get children addicted.

The Los Angeles case centers on a 20-year-old woman, identified as Kaley G.M., who said she became addicted to Google's YouTube and Meta's Instagram at a young age.

The jury found Google and Meta were negligent in the design of both apps and failed to warn about their dangers.

"Today's verdict is a referendum – from a jury, to an entire industry – that accountability has arrived," the

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